

REACH SOCIAL CASE STUDY

Category: Toys & hobbies

\$10K in Three Months. *Without Touching the Discount Lever.*

A toys and hobbies brand in a category that runs on markdowns added an estimated \$10,000 in incremental revenue over three months — and did it without over-discounting or leaning on promos.

VERIFIED TIKTOK SHOP PARTNER

\$10K

INCREMENTAL REVENUE, 3 MONTHS

3 months

COMPOUNDING, NOT SPIKING

No promos

GROWTH WITHOUT DISCOUNT DEPENDENCE

01 Setup

Toys and hobbies is one of the most discount-driven categories on TikTok Shop. The default growth motion is a markdown: run a promo, buy a spike in GMV, watch it fall back when the promo ends. Every brand in the category knows the move, which is exactly why it stops working — and why margin goes with it. This brand came to us with growth stalled and the obvious lever already sitting in everyone else's hand.

02 Problem

Stalled GMV in a discount-led category is a trap with two doors. Door one: discount harder, buy the number, and teach the shopper to wait for the next markdown. Door two: do nothing, and watch the shop flatline while competitors buy the impressions you didn't. Most brands take door one, because it produces a chart that looks like growth inside 30 days. It just doesn't hold.

Operator note — A discount-bought GMV spike and a durable GMV base look identical on a 30-day chart. They look nothing alike on a 90-day one.

03 The No-Discount Growth Path

The No-Discount Growth Path treats the markdown as the last lever, not the first. The premise is simple: if the category's default is a promo, then anything you build that isn't a promo is a structural advantage, because nobody else is building it. So the work moves off pricing and onto operations — goals set against what the shop can actually sustain, and a cadence tight enough to catch drift before it becomes a reason to panic-discount. Slower on the chart. Much harder for a competitor to take away.

04 The moves



Hold

We held the discount and promo levers where they were instead of reaching for them when growth stalled. In this category that is the decision, not a detail — every point of margin given away early becomes the price of entry for the month after.



Align

We worked the account closely with the brand against its stated goals, inside that constraint. Week by week rather than quarter by quarter: what the shop needed to hit, what it was actually doing, and what could move without opening the promo door.

05 Result

Over three months, the account produced an estimated \$10,000 in incremental revenue — built without over-discounting and without leaning on the promo playbook the category defaults to. No spike, no giveback.

THE RESULT, IN ONE NUMBER

Stalled



\$10K

BEFORE · GMV GROWTH IN A DISCOUNT-LED CATEGORY

AFTER · INCREMENTAL REVENUE, 3 MONTHS

Promo-led category default

No added discounting

Estimated incremental revenue over the three-month window. The brand is anonymized; figures are the team's reported estimate.

\$10K

INCREMENTAL REVENUE (ESTIMATED)

3 months

SUSTAINED, NOT SPIKED

None

ADDED DISCOUNTING OR PROMO RELIANCE

The number matters less than its shape. Revenue earned without a markdown behind it doesn't have to be re-earned at a deeper discount next month, and it doesn't reset what the shopper thinks the product is worth. That is a base, not a peak — which is the entire point of building it slowly.

06

Operator takeaway

Discount-heavy categories punish the brands that play their game best. If growth only shows up when the promo does, you don't have a TikTok Shop business — you have a markdown schedule with a storefront attached. Treat the shop as retail instead: set goals against what the operation can actually hold, work the account weekly, and keep the discount lever in reserve for a moment when it is worth something. The growth arrives slower. It also stays.

Growing a TikTok Shop in a discount-driven category?

[Book a TikTok Shop intro call →](#)

reachsocial.co · hello@reachsocial.co